



— RELOCATION GUIDE

Southland

Murihiku

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Southland.

Room to live, close to work. Fiordland on your doorstep.

Southland is New Zealand's southernmost region: a broad green plain running down to a wild coast, with Fiordland at one end and Rakiura across the strait. In the middle sits a base hospital, and the most affordable city in New Zealand.

~103k

people across the region

~57k

in Invercargill

~10 min

across the city, at any hour

~9.45pm

sunset in late December

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why people love Southland

Southland is home to some of our most contented clinicians. Once people see it, they understand why.

Clinical pay in New Zealand is set nationally. You earn the same in Invercargill as in Auckland or Queenstown. What changes is what it costs to live, and here it costs less than anywhere else in the country.

Invercargill has the lowest house prices of any New Zealand city, by a clear margin. A large four-bedroom family home on a proper section, ten minutes from the hospital, costs less than a compact apartment in Queenstown two hours north.

If long, hot summers and big-city buzz are what you want, Invercargill is not that. If you are drawn to friendly people, room to breathe and Fiordland on your doorstep, Southland could be a great choice. Bring a good coat, plan your trips north, and life here is refreshingly easy.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A home, quickly

On a single clinical salary you can buy almost immediately; on two, comfortably, and still travel.

Real hospital medicine

A base hospital covering a whole region, with broad, varied work.

Time back

Ten minutes to work, free parking, and summer light until nearly ten at night.

Fiordland on the doorstep

World Heritage wilderness two hours from your front door.

GOOD TO KNOW

Weather

Cool and changeable rather than hot, so layers and a good coat are part of the uniform. Autumn is often glorious.

Distances

Queenstown is about two hours, Dunedin about two and a half, Christchurch an easy flight.

Flying long-haul

International trips connect through Christchurch or Auckland, or start with a drive to Queenstown. Allow a little extra time.

Seasonal light

At 46 degrees south, summer evenings stay light until nearly ten, and midwinter days are short and cosy.

Monday to Friday

10 MIN COMMUTE

Ten minutes to work, and free parking. The streets are wide and the traffic light, so the drive is easy.

○ After work, summer

Light until nearly ten. Oreti Beach, a round of golf, a bike ride or the estuary.

○ After work, winter

Evenings draw in and life moves happily indoors. Invercargill has an excellent range of pools, gyms, a velodrome and community sport for its size.

○ Saturday

Bluff for oysters and the walk out to Stirling Point, Riverton for the coast, or the Catlins along the Southern Scenic Route.

○ Sunday

Te Anau and the edge of Fiordland, two hours up the road. Or the ferry to Rakiura, where you can hear kiwi in the evening.



Te Anau on an autumn morning: the Sunday drive, two hours from Invercargill, where the road meets Fiordland.

Green farmland and wild, beautiful edges

The heart of Southland is gentle green farmland, and its edges are some of the most spectacular country anywhere on earth.

The middle of Southland is farmland: the Southland Plains, some of the most productive pasture in the country, running from the Takitimu Mountains down to the sea. Invercargill sits near the southern edge on the Waihōpai River, with the Oreti and New River estuaries beside it.

Gore is an hour north-east, on the Maitara River. North-west, past Winton and Lumsden, the land climbs into the Te Anau basin and then into Fiordland: 1.2 million hectares of World Heritage wilderness and some of the highest rainfall on the planet.

South of the city, Bluff sits on its hill above Foveaux Strait. An hour by ferry beyond it is Rakiura, Stewart Island: eighty-five per cent national park and around four hundred people. East, the coast runs into the Catlins.



The Catlins coast, east along the Southern Scenic Route. The Catlins straddle Southland and Otago.

Summer

DEC – FEB

18–22°C. Mild rather than hot, and endlessly light.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

14–18°C. Often the best of the year.

Winter

JUN – AUG

8–11°C. Cool and cosy, with crisp frosty mornings. Snow at sea level is rare.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Fresh and breezy, with lambs in the paddocks and the long evenings returning.

What the numbers don't tell you

- ✓ The light. Around the solstice it is light from before five in the morning until nearly ten at night. In midwinter the days are short, which is when the region's pools, clubs and cafés come into their own.
- ✓ The wind is a regular companion, especially in spring, when the westerly comes straight off the Southern Ocean. A good coat is the first thing most newcomers buy.
- ✓ It is cool rather than cold. The maritime climate rarely freezes hard and rarely gets hot, but it changes quickly. Locals dress for four seasons in a day.
- ✓ The aurora australis is visible on clear, active nights. Very few places offer that from the back garden.

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Words you'll hear

Murihiku is Southland in te reo Māori, “the last joint of the tail”, and this is the rohe of Ngāi Tahu. Rakiura is Stewart Island. The Southland burr, a rolled “r” from Scottish settlers, is the only real regional accent in the country. The Stags are the provincial rugby side; you will soon be cheering for them too.

Healthcare and work in Southland

This is one of Southland's great strengths: the region has its own base hospital, and that changes what a career here can look like.

Public hospital and specialist services are delivered by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. The base hospital in Invercargill serves the whole region, roughly a hundred thousand people over an area larger than Wales, carrying acute medicine and surgery, emergency, intensive care, maternity, paediatrics, imaging and a full outpatient service.

Beyond the city, care runs through a rural network: community and district services across the plains, and rural facilities serving Gore, the Te Anau basin, Fiordland and Rakiura. Retrieval and transfer, by road and by air, are a normal part of the working year.

Complex and highly specialised work is referred to Dunedin, about two and a half hours away, and to Christchurch for some tertiary services. That relationship is close and well established.

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base hospital for the
whole region
in Invercargill

~100k

people in the catchment
over an area larger than
Wales

~2½ hr

to the tertiary centre in
Dunedin

BASE HOSPITAL

Real hospital breadth

As the region's hospital, you see everything it produces. Scope is wide, and you make more of the decisions yourself.

FIORDLAND · RAKIURA

Rural and remote reach

Wilderness and island medicine, search-and-rescue interaction, and a tourism injury load from the Great Walks and the sounds.

FARMING COUNTRY

An agricultural caseload

Farm injury, occupational health and rural mental health are a real and distinctive part of the work.

ACROSS THE PLAINS

Caring for a rural population

Age-related medicine, orthopaedics and chronic disease are a large part of the work, and good planning bridges the distances.

MID-SIZED SERVICE

Progression, sooner

Visibility and responsibility come earlier than in a large hospital. Several clinicians we have placed here stepped up faster than they expected.

GROWING TEAMS

A warm welcome for international staff

Services here actively recruit from overseas, so you will be welcomed and valued. Many teams are growing, which means real opportunity to help shape them.



Working with te ao Māori

This is the rohe of Ngāi Tahu. Iwi-led health providers are an established part of care, and the region's equity picture, rural, dispersed and with a significant Māori and Pacific population in the city, is central to the work. Expect karakia at the start of meetings and whānau involved in decisions. Nobody expects you to arrive fluent; a genuine effort is warmly welcomed.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ What is the catchment for my service, and how much rural, outreach or island work is involved?
- ☐ What is the on-call pattern, and how is it paid under the relevant collective agreement?
- ☐ What gets referred to Dunedin or Christchurch in my specialty, and what is my role in stabilising and transferring?
- ☐ What orientation, supervision and cultural induction is there for clinicians new to New Zealand?
- ☐ What study support exists, including for courses and conferences further afield?
- ☐ Is there relocation support, and help finding housing and schools?

Where to live in and around Invercargill

Invercargill is a city of wide streets and generous sections. With the commute taken out of the equation, the choice comes down to character, and how far out of the city you want to be.

NORTH · ESTABLISHED

Waikiwi & Grasmere

Well regarded and well served by schools. A common landing spot for relocating clinical families, and close to the hospital.

EAST · CENTRAL

Windsor & Georgetown

Solid family housing, good value even by local standards, and walkable to schools and shops.

NEAR QUEENS PARK

Avenal & Gladstone

Older character housing, villas and bungalows under mature trees, beside the city's large and genuinely lovely park.

SOUTH & EAST EDGES

Rosedale & Newfield

Friendly, affordable suburbs, and the best value in an already great-value city.

10 MIN · BUSH BLOCKS

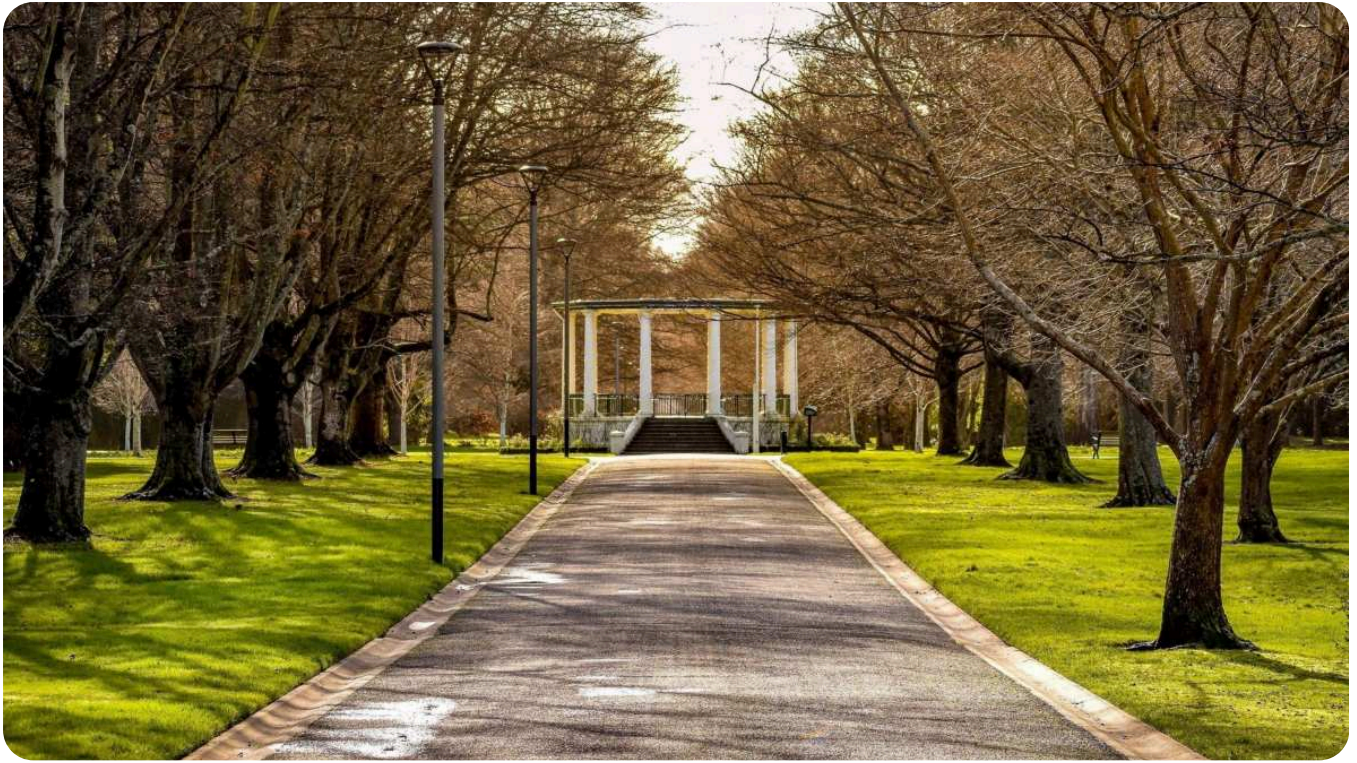
Otatara

Semi-rural lifestyle blocks in native bush between the city and the estuary. Where people go for land and trees.

WALKABLE

The city centre

Compact and being steadily redeveloped, with apartments appearing. Ideal if you would rather skip the garden.



Queens Park, Invercargill: the city's big botanic park, beside the character streets of Avenal and Gladstone.

TOWN	FROM THE CITY	SUITS
Bluff	30 min south	Port-town character, the oysters and the Rakiura ferry. Affordable, breezy and much loved.
Riverton / Aparima	40 min west	A seaside river-mouth town, arguably the prettiest spot in the region.
Winton	30 min north	A tidy farming town with a school and an easy commute.
Gore	1 hr north-east	The region's second town, with its own services, schools and strong identity.
Te Anau	2 hr north-west	A lakeside town with a rural health service: a lifestyle choice in its own right rather than a commute.
Rakiura / Stewart Island	1 hr by ferry from Bluff	A unique island-community posting for a clinician who loves remote practice.

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ Insulation, heating and ventilation. Southland winters are cool and damp, so ask for the Healthy Homes compliance statement.
- ☐ Whether to rent at all. Many clinicians rent for six months to learn the city, then buy.
- ☐ The school zone, at the exact address. Popular schools are zoned by address.



Invercargill housing buys space: a real garden, room for a barbecue, and a lawn for the kids.



Long, empty beaches and easy evenings outside.



Native bush is never far from home.

Getting around Southland

Getting around inside Southland is the easiest of any region we cover, and the open roads lead straight to Fiordland, the Catlins and Queenstown. Longer trips just need a little planning.

Ten minutes across Invercargill, at any hour. The city was laid out on a generous grid, and it still flows easily. Parking is free and abundant, including at the hospital. Clinicians tell us the reclaimed time is the thing they would least want to give back.

Most households run two cars, the best way to enjoy the region, and a useful city bus network covers town. In winter, watch for black ice on the plains at dawn, and always check conditions on the Milford road.



Beyond the city the roads open up: farmland, beech forest and snow on the tops.

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Across Invercargill	10 min
City → airport	10 min
City → Bluff	30 min

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
City → Gore	1 hr
City → Te Anau	2 hr
City → Queenstown	2 hr
City → Dunedin	~2½ hr
City → Milford Sound	~4 hr
City → Christchurch	6 hr, or 1 hr 15 flying
Bluff → Oban, Rakiura	1 hr by ferry, 20 min by air

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Flying home

Invercargill Airport, ten minutes from the city, has regular flights to Christchurch and Auckland. Queenstown, about two hours' drive, is the nearest airport with direct trans-Tasman flights. Long-haul trips home take a little longer from here, so allow a full day at each end and book ahead if you will fly to Europe or Africa several times a year.



Kingston's old railway station, at the southern tip of Lake Wakatipu, on the drive from Southland to Queenstown.

What it costs to live here

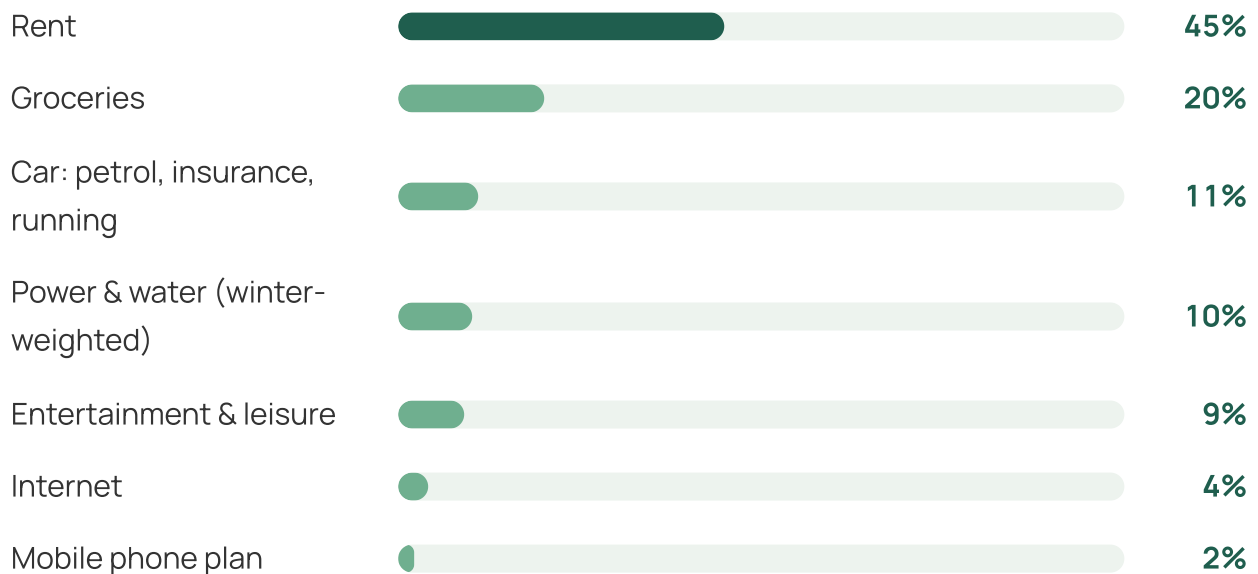
Invercargill has the lowest house prices of any city in New Zealand, by a clear margin. On a clinical salary that changes what your money is for.

Clinical pay is national. You arrive on the same salary you would earn in Auckland, Queenstown or Wellington, with no regional adjustment. You simply keep more of it.

On QV's August 2026 figures, the average Invercargill property is valued at roughly three-fifths of the national average. That is the gap the rest of this section is about.

Most clinicians we place in Southland buy within their first year or two, rather than renting for a decade while they save. Beyond the house, they tend to travel more, work fewer extra shifts, and reach financial decisions years earlier than colleagues on identical pay elsewhere.

Where a month goes



Proportions, not amounts: one person on a mid-range budget. Rent is the smallest share of any region we cover.

WORTH PLANNING FOR

Winter heating

Winter is cool and long, and because houses are affordable, buying one already well insulated is realistic.

PLAN AHEAD

Getting home

If you will fly to Europe or South Africa a few times a year, budget for it, and for the drive to Queenstown.

YOU WILL USE IT

Good outdoor kit

A serious coat, boots and layers, and the gear for Fiordland, which you will use.

ESSENTIAL

A car, probably two

Your housing savings cover it comfortably.



Why there are no prices here

Figures date quickly, so we leave them out. For today's numbers, use Tenancy Services market rent data, the Sorted budget planner and current listings, and compare Southland against the city you are leaving. One exception: tourism demand makes Te Anau, Fiordland's gateway town, noticeably dearer, so start your search there early.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER

- ✓ The most affordable city housing in New Zealand, on national clinical pay.
- ✓ Most people here buy rather than rent, and sooner than they planned.
- ✓ Winter power and trips home are the main costs to plan for, and both are smaller than what you save.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Southland

Southland is the region where I have seen people build the most life the fastest. A base hospital, a house bought within a few years, and Fiordland two hours away.

The weather is the thing I always mention, and a good coat sorts most of it. The families who choose Southland tend to stay, and then quietly recommend it to everyone they know.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Christmas with friends: newcomer communities across New Zealand look out for one another.



Time on the water is an ordinary weekend here, not a holiday.

Food and everyday life in the south

Southland food is generous and unpretentious. It comes from the sea, the farms and a hundred and fifty years of Scottish home cooking.

Bluff oysters are the region's great annual event: wild dredge oysters from Foveaux Strait, in season roughly March to August. There is a festival, there are queues, and a local calendar built around the opening.

Blue cod is the correct order at any chippy in the region. Crayfish, pāua and mussels come off the same coast, and tītī, muttonbird, remains a customary harvest on the islands off Rakiura. And cheese rolls, at every café, fundraiser and school gala. Locals take them very seriously, and you soon will too.

Inland it is dairy and sheep country, with a real culture of home baking and preserving. The farmers' markets in Invercargill and Gore cover produce, meat and baking. You can eat extremely well from within fifty kilometres, and cheaply.

The rhythm of the year

- ✓ Summer is lived outdoors, late: barbecues at nine, cricket, the beach, the estuary.
- ✓ Winter is lived indoors, well: pools, gyms, a velodrome and a strong club culture.
- ✓ Sport and motorsport are the social glue. Joining a club is the fastest way to know people properly.
- ✓ Newcomers are noticed and warmly welcomed. Southland hospitality is the real thing.

Worth planning for

- ☐ Everyday shopping is well covered. For bigger shopping trips, Dunedin or Christchurch make a good day or weekend away, and online orders arrive in a day or two.
- ☐ Major touring concerts and exhibitions usually play Dunedin or Christchurch, which makes for a fun weekend away. Local theatre, music and community events fill the calendar in between.
- ☐ Invercargill has Asian and Indian grocers. If a particular cuisine is central to how your family eats, ask us and we will check what is available.

Weekends in Fiordland, Rakiura and the coast

Weekends are where Southland really shines. Beaches, rivers and parks are minutes away, and two hours from your front door is one of the great wildernesses on earth.



Oreti Beach

~15 MIN

Firm open sand for kilometres, where Burt Munro tested his motorcycle. Fresh, wild and often all yours.



Bluff & Stirling Point

~30 MIN

The famous Stirling Point signpost, the hill walk above the port, and the oysters.



Riverton & the western coast

~40 MIN

A river-mouth town, beaches, and the road towards Fiordland's southern edge.



Te Anau & the edge of Fiordland

~2 HR

Where the road ends and the World Heritage area starts. Lakeside towns, and a glowworm cave under the lake.



Milford Sound

~4 HR

One of the great drives anywhere. Go on a wet day, when the waterfalls are extraordinary and the buses fewer.



Doubtful Sound: larger, more peaceful and more secluded than Milford, via Lake Manapouri.

The Milford Track is booked out a year ahead by people flying from the other side of the world; you would be two hours from the start. The Kepler and Routeburn are within easy reach of Te Anau, with a lifetime of shorter tracks around them. Takahē and kākāpō country is close by, and conservation here is a live, visible thing.

Rakiura is an hour by ferry from Bluff, or twenty minutes by light aircraft. It is one of the best places in the world to see kiwi in the wild, on a beach at dusk. There is the Rakiura Track, Ulva Island's bird sanctuary, and a night sky with almost no light pollution. Southlanders treat it as a long weekend rather than an expedition.



Moss, beech and crown fern: the forest you walk through on almost every Fiordland track.



Pīwakawaka, the fantail, follows walkers along the tracks here and across the country.



Most New Zealanders visit Fiordland once. You would live two hours away.

What people do at the weekend

- ✓ Saturday morning at the Invercargill farmers' market, then a walk or a picnic in Queens Park.
- ✓ A walk or a gallop of the dog along Oreti Beach, or mountain biking in the bush at Sandy Point.
- ✓ Trout fishing on the Mataura or Oreti, or oysters at Bluff when the season opens.
- ✓ Kids' sport in the morning and the Stags at Rugby Park in the afternoon, in season.
- ✓ Splash Palace, the city's aquatic centre, on a cold winter Sunday.
- ✓ A night away in Te Anau, the Catlins or on Rakiura.



New Zealand sea lions haul out on southern beaches from the Otago Peninsula to the Catlins. Give them space.

Day trips and weekends further afield

Invercargill is a base for some of the most loved country in New Zealand. Wilderness, wildlife coast and lake resorts are all a day trip or an easy weekend away.

To the south, Bluff and the Rakiura ferry are half an hour away. To the east, the Southern Scenic Route runs into the Catlins, with its petrified forest, dolphins and waterfalls. North-west, Te Anau and Manapōuri open the door to Fiordland, Milford Sound and Doubtful Sound.

North, Queenstown and Arrowtown are about two hours away: ski fields in winter, lakes and restaurants all year, and the nearest international airport. Dunedin, the nearest larger city, adds a tertiary hospital, a covered stadium, galleries and the Otago Peninsula's wildlife.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Invercargill Airport	About 10 min	Domestic flights to Christchurch and Auckland
Oreti Beach	About 15 min	Kilometres of firm sand on the city's doorstep; cool water, big skies
Bluff & Stirling Point	About 30 min	The famous signpost, coastal walks and oysters in season
Colac Bay	About 45 min	Southland's best-known surf beach, with a relaxed seaside settlement
Rakiura / Stewart Island	30 min to Bluff, then 1 hr ferry	Kiwi in the wild, Ulva Island and starry skies
The Catlins (Curio Bay)	About 1½ hrs	Petrified forest, Hector's dolphins and waterfalls
Queenstown Airport	About 2 hrs	The nearest international airport, with trans-Tasman flights
Nearest ski fields	About 2–2½ hrs	The Remarkables and Coronet Peak above Queenstown: a day trip or an easy weekend
Te Anau & Manapōuri	About 2 hrs	Fiordland's gateway: lake walks, glowworm caves, Doubtful Sound cruises

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Dunedin	About 2½ hrs	The nearest larger city: shows, galleries, the stadium and the peninsula
Milford Sound	About 4 hrs	One of the world's great drives, ending at the sea

FERRY FROM BLUFF

Rakiura / Stewart Island

A long weekend in another world: the village of Oban, Ulva Island's birdlife, and kiwi foraging on the beach at dusk.

ABOUT 1½ HRS

The Catlins

Curio Bay's petrified forest, Hector's dolphins at Porpoise Bay, Waipapa Point lighthouse and McLean Falls.

ABOUT 2 HRS

Te Anau & Fiordland

Lakeside walks, the glowworm caves, day sections of the Kepler Track, and cruises on Milford and Doubtful Sounds.

ABOUT 2 HRS

Queenstown & Arrowtown

Skiing in winter, lake cruises and gold-rush history all year. All the fun of Queenstown, without paying to live there.

40-45 MIN

Riverton & the south coast

A pretty river-mouth town with cafés and a museum, and the surf at Colac Bay just down the road.

ABOUT 1 HR

Gore & the rivers

World-class brown trout fishing on the Mataura, and a friendly country town with its own galleries.

ABOUT 2½ HRS

Dunedin

Concerts and rugby at the covered stadium, museums, and albatross and penguins on the Otago Peninsula.



Queenstown's waterfront, about two hours north: the region's favourite weekend escape and nearest international airport.



Arrowtown's gold-rush main street, a short drive past Queenstown.



Learning to snowboard on a Central Otago ski field, an easy winter weekend from Invercargill.

Schools and family life

Space, safety, sport, short commutes and enough left at the end of the month to actually do things together. Southland is very good with children.

Family life here has room in it. Ten-minute commutes mean parents make it to practice and dinner, sections are big enough for a trampoline and a vegetable garden, and children can bike to school on quiet, flat streets. Southlanders are notably welcoming, and the region's health workforce has welcomed international families for decades.

Invercargill punches above its weight for children. Queens Park has playgrounds, an animal reserve and an aviary; Splash Palace has hydrosides and a learn-to-swim pool; and Bill Richardson Transport World and E Hayes, home of Burt Munro's motorcycle, are favourites on wet days. The city library runs storytimes and holiday programmes.

Schools and early learning

- ✓ State schooling is free at primary and secondary level, with a voluntary donation. There are also state-integrated schools, often with a church character, such as Verdon College, the city's Catholic secondary school.
- ✓ Long-established secondary schools include Southland Boys' and Southland Girls' High Schools and James Hargest College. Gore, Winton and Te Anau have their own schools.
- ✓ Popular schools run enrolment zones, so settle the school before the street. Read any school's report from the Education Review Office at ero.govt.nz.
- ✓ Up to 20 hours a week of early childhood education is funded for three to five-year-olds, at kindergartens and centres across the region.
- ✓ The Southern Institute of Technology in Invercargill offers tertiary study close to home; the University of Otago is in Dunedin.

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Specialist care for children

Day-to-day paediatric care is provided locally, and some specialist services are in Dunedin. Families tell us the support around those trips is good, and it is worth asking about if your child has particular needs.

IT SUITS YOU BEST IF...

You want to own a home

Soon, on clinical pay, without a decade of saving first.

You want breadth

Base-hospital scope, with the rural reach of Fiordland and Rakiura.

Your weekends are mountains, water or birds

Few places on earth beat this as a base.

WORTH WEIGHING UP IF...

You love long, hot summers

Southland summers are mild and light-filled. For more heat, Hawke's Bay, the Bay of Plenty and Nelson are warmer.

Your specialty needs tertiary volume

Complex work goes to Dunedin or Christchurch, so ask how your service links in.

You want big-city buzz

Invercargill is a friendly, easy-going small city. Dunedin and Queenstown are close for nights out.

Short winter days affect you

Many people love the seasons here. A bright, warm home and a club or sport make winter easy.



Bring a good coat. Everything else over-delivers.

THE ETHICARE TEAM



Discover Southland once, and you will recommend it to everyone.

Your Southland address book

Southland's migrant life is centred on Invercargill, where the Southland Multicultural Council at Community House on Kelvin Street, English Language Partners and the Southland Muslim Association are the main anchors, alongside a growing Filipino and South Asian presence linked to dairy farming and healthcare. Gore and Te Anau are small: for specialist food and most faith communities, people head to Invercargill, Dunedin or Queenstown, or order online.

COUNCILS

Invercargill City Council

Rates, rubbish, building consents, parks, pools, libraries and the city buses

icc.govt.nz

Environment Southland

The regional council: rivers, flood warnings, air quality and the coast

es.govt.nz

Southland District Council

Council services for Winton, Riverton, Te Anau, Stewart Island and the rural district

southlanddc.govt.nz

Gore District Council

Council services for Gore, Mataura and the eastern district

goredc.govt.nz

NZTA Journey Planner

Live road conditions, including closures on the Milford road

journeys.nzta.govt.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with tenancy, employment and everyday questions

cab.org.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Southland Multicultural Council

The region's migrant umbrella body: social events, youth, women's and men's groups, workshops and online language classes. At Community House, 46 Kelvin Street, Invercargill

03 214 9296 southlandmulticultural.co.nz

English Language Partners Invercargill

English classes, ESOL literacy, ESOL Road Code, English for job seekers and employees, home tutoring and the NZ Certificate in English Language. 184 Esk Street; most courses free for residents

03 218 2736 englishlanguage.org.nz/invercargill

Invercargill City Council: Welcoming Communities

The council's newcomer programme, with links to settlement, English and community contacts across Invercargill

icc.govt.nz/community/welcoming-communities

GETTING OUT AND SETTLING IN

Southland NZ

The regional visitor guide: Fiordland, the Catlins, Rakiura and what's on

southlandnz.com

Department of Conservation

Great Walk and hut bookings, track alerts for Fiordland and Rakiura

doc.govt.nz

Gore District Council: Welcoming Newcomers

A community development coordinator who connects newcomers in Gore and Mataura with local groups and services

goredc.govt.nz/our-community/welcoming-newcomers-and-migrants

King Solomon Athletic Club

Filipino sports club for Invercargill and wider Southland, listed by the Philippine Embassy, and a good way into the local Filipino community

philembassy.org.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free help with tenancy, employment and settling-in questions

cab.org.nz

Shakti

Specialist support for migrant women and children affected by family violence; free and confidential

0800 742 584 shakti.org.nz

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

English Language Partners Southland (Facebook)

Class dates, conversation groups and newcomer events in Invercargill

facebook.com/EnglishLanguagePartnersSouthland

Southland Multicultural Council social pages

Linked from the council website: event notices for festivals and for the women's, men's and youth groups
southlandmulticultural.co.nz

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Southland Muslim Association

Invercargill's prayer centre in Hawthorndale, used for the five daily prayers and community gatherings; a registered charity since 2009

register.charities.govt.nz/Charity/CC39188

Hindu, Sikh and Buddhist worship

There's no confirmed temple or gurdwara in Southland; ask the Southland Multicultural Council about current home-based satsangs and festival gatherings. The nearest established temples are in Dunedin and Christchurch

hcnz.org

Jewish community

There's no synagogue in Southland; the nearest congregation is in Dunedin. The NZ Jewish Council can connect you

nzjc.org.nz

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Tasti Bitz – The Spice Shop

Asian and international spices and ingredients at 12 Kelvin Street, Invercargill

03 214 9329 yellow.co.nz/invercargill/grocery

Halal meat

There's no dedicated halal butcher confirmed; ask the Southland Muslim Association where members currently buy

register.charities.govt.nz/Charity/CC39188

Kosher food

Nothing kosher is sold locally; families order from Auckland or Wellington suppliers through the Jewish community

nzjc.org.nz

Asian Grocer (online)

National online Asian grocer, useful for Gore and Te Anau especially

asiangrocer.co.nz

SA Shop NZ (online)

South African groceries delivered nationwide

sashopnz.co.nz

UK Foods (online)

British groceries delivered nationwide

ukfoods.co.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE Invercargill

Discount supermarket at 95 Tay Street

03 214 4864 paknsave.co.nz

Woolworths Invercargill

Full-range supermarket at 172 Tay Street

03 211 3100 woolworths.co.nz

New World Windsor and New World Elles Road

Two New Worlds: 51 Windsor Street (Windsor) and 244 Elles Road (Strathern)

newworld.co.nz

SuperValue Plaza and Four Square stores, Invercargill

SuperValue at 103 Yarrow Street; Four Squares in Ascot (Tay St), Newfield (Tweed St) and West Invercargill (Ettrick St)

yellow.co.nz/southland-region/supermarkets

Gore supermarkets

New World (8 Irk Street) and Woolworths (Medway Street), plus Bin Inn for bulk foods (82 Broughton Street)

yellow.co.nz/southland-region/supermarkets

FreshChoice Te Anau

Te Anau's supermarket at 5 Milford Crescent; prices reflect the visitor market, so many locals stock up in Invercargill or Queenstown

freshchoice.co.nz

Invercargill and Gore farmers' markets

Weekend farmers' markets with produce, meat and baking; check the council what's-on listings for the current day and venue

icc.govt.nz

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts school finder

Find schools and enrolment zones for any Invercargill, Gore or Te Anau address

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

School uniforms

Most Southland schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop or office, and many PTAs run second-hand sales. Ask at enrolment

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Invercargill City Libraries

Central library and Bluff branch: storytimes, holiday programmes, free Wi-Fi and computers

icc.govt.nz/services/libraries

Plunket

Free Well Child checks and parent groups; PlunketLine is 24/7

0800 933 922 plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood sessions in Invercargill, Gore and rural Southland

playcentre.org.nz

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property: Southland rentals

The main rental listings site for Invercargill, Gore and Te Anau

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/southland

realestate.co.nz: Southland rentals

A second set of rental listings from local agencies

realestate.co.nz/residential/rental/southland

Build Southland

The regional guide to housing: renting, buying and building in Southland

buildsouthland.nz

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check fair rents by suburb before you apply

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Invercargill City Council rates

Rates information for any Invercargill address

icc.govt.nz/rates-building-property/1-rates

Trade Me flatmates

Rooms and flatshares for your first weeks

trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

Invercargill city buses

Six routes (Clifton, Kingswell, Newfield, Hargest, Waverley, Waikiwi), plus school buses; you can flag a bus anywhere on its route. Live tracking on ride.guide icc.govt.nz/services/buses

Bee Card

Invercargill's tag-on, tag-off bus fare card, which replaced the old Bus Smart card
beecard.co.nz

Invercargill Airport

Ten minutes from the city, with flights to Christchurch and Auckland and light aircraft to Rakiura/Stewart Island. Queenstown (two hours) has trans-Tasman flights
invercargillairport.co.nz

InterCity

Coaches linking Invercargill, Gore, Te Anau, Dunedin and Queenstown
intercity.co.nz

Stewart Island ferry (Bluff to Oban)

Passenger ferry across Foveaux Strait, about an hour
stewartislandexperience.co.nz

NZTA driver licensing agents

Find the nearest AA or VTNZ agent in Invercargill or Gore for licence conversion
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

NZTA road conditions

Check the Milford road and frost or snow warnings before winter drives
journeys.nzta.govt.nz

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo: Invercargill

Crowd-sourced cost of living for Invercargill, which you can compare with your current city
numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Invercargill

Powerswitch

Compare electricity and broadband plans; heating costs matter in Southland
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget planner

A free tool for planning your first months' budget
sorted.org.nz

Stats NZ prices

Official food price and inflation data
stats.govt.nz

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

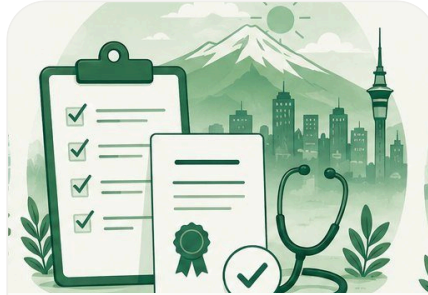
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

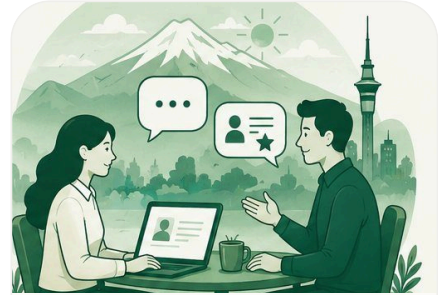
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

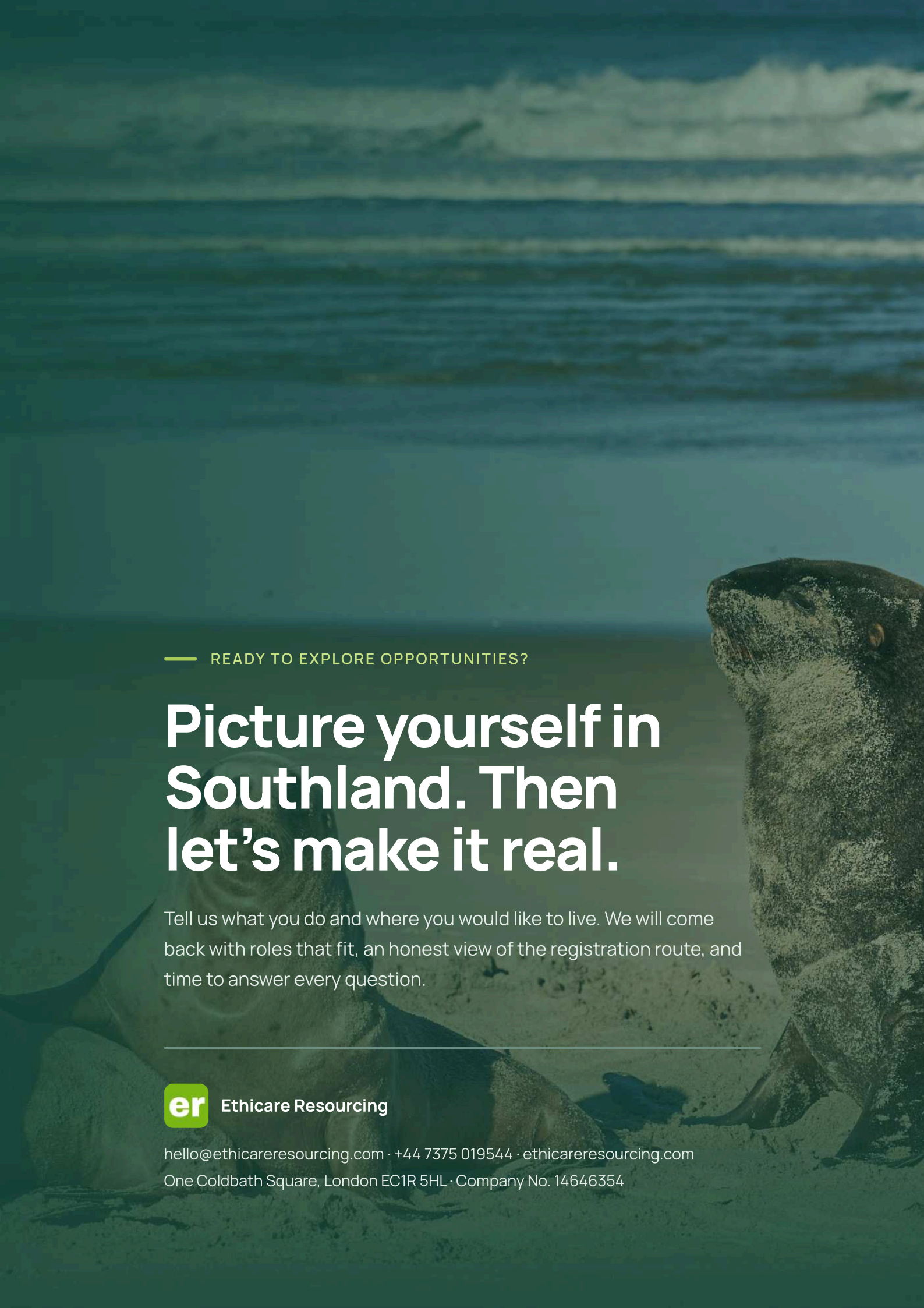
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Southland. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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